

Chapter Title: Preface

Book Title: The Ethics of War and Peace

Book Subtitle: Religious and Secular Perspectives

Book Editor(s): Terry Nardin

Published by: Princeton University Press. (1996)

Stable URL: <https://www.jstor.org/stable/j.ctv173f1cg.3>

JSTOR is a not-for-profit service that helps scholars, researchers, and students discover, use, and build upon a wide range of content in a trusted digital archive. We use information technology and tools to increase productivity and facilitate new forms of scholarship. For more information about JSTOR, please contact support@jstor.org.

Your use of the JSTOR archive indicates your acceptance of the Terms & Conditions of Use, available at <https://about.jstor.org/terms>



JSTOR

Princeton University Press is collaborating with JSTOR to digitize, preserve and extend access to *The Ethics of War and Peace*

Preface

THIS BOOK originated at a conference on the ethics of war and peace held in January 1993 at the Notre Dame of Jerusalem Center. The event was organized by the Ethikon Institute in cooperation with the University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee/Marquette University Center for International Studies and was made possible by a grant from The Pew Charitable Trusts.

The Ethikon Institute is engaged in an ongoing program of dialogues and publications designed to increase our knowledge of the diversity of ethical perspectives that may be brought to bear on major issues of public life. As in other Ethikon projects, the contributors to this book were asked to address a common set of questions. All have revised their chapters to take account of the discussion in Jerusalem and to insure that each chapter contributes to the comparative and dialogic exploration of ethical ideas. The book is thus a product of the Institute's continually evolving efforts to facilitate a useful exchange of ideas between authorities on different ethical traditions and between the communities shaped by those traditions. We hope the chapters that follow will help readers to acquire a better understanding of viewpoints that may be unfamiliar to them and a better sense of the assumptions and limitations of their own points of view.

By dialogue we mean a conversational and comparative inquiry into different views about a common topic—not a debate that can be won or lost, but an exchange of information. In an Ethikon dialogue, the emphasis is on discovery, not persuasion. Dialogue presupposes difference and need not seek to overcome it. But it also presupposes information about the different views, and this means listening to those who can articulate those views.

To generate the information needed for comparison, two chapters have been commissioned on each perspective. The first is a presentation of how the perspective deals with the topic of war/peace ethics, as this topic is defined by the questions that all the contributors were asked to consider. The “presenter” is a reporter, not necessarily an adherent or advocate, though he or she must have enough sympathy with the described perspective to explain its distinctive character. Given the comparative aims of this study, it is not the job of the presenter to refute critics, or to “advance the debate” on a given aspect of the topic, but simply to state, carefully and dispassionately, how the topic-related questions are handled within the tradition on which he or she is reporting. The second chapter on each perspective has been prepared by a “reactor” who also knows the perspective well and whose task is to present an alternative interpretation of controverted issues. Finally, the presentations and reactions are reviewed in

two comparative overviews that seek to identify commonalities and differences, substantive and methodological, among the presented views.

This book is the first in a series of Ethikon Institute studies published by Princeton University Press. Each study will bring together scholars representing a diversity of ethical perspectives, secular and religious, to discuss an important issue of public life. The volumes will be structured to identify significant points of agreement and disagreement among the presented views. The approach taken in individual volumes in the series will depend on the topics discussed and the current state of reflection on those topics, but all will be carefully designed comparative studies rather than collections of loosely related articles.

Like any collaborative project, this one could not have been completed without the cooperation and support of many persons in addition to the authors represented here. Among them were other participants in the Jerusalem conference, many of whose ideas and arguments have found their way into this book: Shukri Abed, Ruben Apresyan, Shlomo Avineri, Chris Brown, Naomi Chazan, Henry Clark, Marie Egan, Sharif Kanaana, Bruce Nichols, Khalil Shikaki, Peter Steinfelds, Mark Tessler, Philippe Van Parijs, Margaret-Rose Welch, and Noam Zohar. Though he was unfortunately unable at the last minute to travel to Jerusalem, Stanley Hauerwas shared his understanding of Christian pacifism with us. We are especially grateful to Michael Cartwright, Sohail Hashmi, and Sarah Tobias, who, though they did not attend the Jerusalem conference, agreed to write chapters for this book. The project owes most, however, to Ethikon's founder and president, Philip Valera, who developed the model of comparative analysis and focused dialogue on which this series is based.

Special thanks are due to Msgr. Dr. Richard Mathes, chargé of the Holy See and director of the Notre Dame of Jerusalem Center, for the excellence of his hospitality. Dan McIntyre, formerly of The Pew Charitable Trusts, provided much excellent advice. Lea Ann King, who chairs the Ethikon board of directors, lent valuable assistance in the organization of the conference. We benefited from the criticism of several anonymous readers, and we are especially grateful to Ann Himmelberger Wald, our editor at Princeton University Press, for her confidence in the project. We also thank Jane Nardin for providing substantive and editorial guidance.

All royalties from the sale of this book go to the Ethikon Institute to support its programs on intersocietal relations, civil society, bio-environmental ethics, and family life.